Sonde

Accessibility Health Check

https://providenceri.gov

934

0 1000

Excellent

May 22, 2026
Provided free by Sonde

https://daylight.sonde.life/usgov/providenceri-gov/

1 pages **66** findings **0** critical **5** high **30** medium **31** low **66** avg/page **655** elements
55 with findings **91.6%** ECR **3m 14s** total **3m 14s** per page

Top Findings

Copy a direct link to share a finding · Open a discussion to give feedback on a finding

HIGH Image has no accessible name in the accessibility tree. Screen readers will skip or announce it generically. WCAG 1.1.1

Page: / WCAG 1.1.1

Element:

```
<!-- a11y: role="image" -->
```

SONDE FIX PLAN

Add alt text to the image. If decorative, mark with role="presentation" or alt="". WCAG 1.1.1 requires text alternatives for non-text content.

HIGH Image has no accessible name in the accessibility tree. Screen readers will skip or announce it generically. WCAG 1.1.1

Page: / WCAG 1.1.1

Element:

```
<!-- a11y: role="image" -->
```

SONDE FIX PLAN

Add alt text to the image. If decorative, mark with role="presentation" or alt="". WCAG 1.1.1 requires text alternatives for non-text content.

HIGH Image has no accessible name in the accessibility tree. Screen readers will skip or announce it generically. WCAG 1.1.1

Page: / WCAG 1.1.1

Element:

```
<!-- a11y: role="image" -->
```

SONDE FIX PLAN

Add alt text to the image. If decorative, mark with role="presentation" or alt="". WCAG 1.1.1 requires text alternatives for non-text content.

HIGH Console error: ReferenceError: pagespeed is not defined at HTMLImageElement.onload (https://www.providenceri.gov/:633:1618)

Page: /

Source: https://www.providenceri.gov/:632 MEDIUM

SONDE FIX PLAN

Add Strict-Transport-Security header with max-age of at least 31536000 Add X-Frame-Options: DENY or SAMEORIGIN Add Referrer-Policy: strict-origin-when-cross-origin or no-referrer

HIGH

Focus jumps backward from "Show Accessibility options toolbar" to "close accessibility options toolbar" (visual distance: 422px). No explicit tabIndex — likely a DOM order issue.

WCAG 2.4.3

Page: / WCAG 2.4.3

Element:

```
<div>close accessibility options toolbar</div>
```

SONDE FIX PLAN

Reorder elements in the DOM to match the visual layout.

MEDIUM

All page content should be contained by landmarks: Fix any of the following: Some page content is not contained by landmarks

Page: /

Element:

```
<div id="skip3" tabindex="0" role="link" class="skipper" style="min-width:25px;min-h
eight:25px;" onclick="skipto('access');" onkeydown="keypress(event,'skip2access');"
title="skip to accessibility opt...
```

SONDE FIX PLAN

Ensure all page content is contained by landmarks. See: https://www.w3.org/WAI/WCAG22/quickref/

MEDIUM

All page content should be contained by landmarks: Fix any of the following: Some page content is not contained by landmarks

Page: /

Element:

```
<div class="controls" role="link" tabindex="0" zindex="9998" onclick="showpanel('sho
w');" onfocus="showpanel('show');" id="access" title="Show Accessibility options too
lbar" aria-label="Show Accessibi...
```

SONDE FIX PLAN

Ensure all page content is contained by landmarks. See: https://www.w3.org/WAI/WCAG22/quickref/

MEDIUM

All page content should be contained by landmarks: Fix any of the following: Some page content is not contained by landmarks

Page: /

Element:

```
<div id="skip1" tabindex="0" role="link" class="skipper" onclick="skipto('menu');" o
nkeydown="keypress(event,'skip2menu');" title="skip to menu" aria-label="skip to men
u">Skip To Menu</div>
```

SONDE FIX PLAN

Ensure all page content is contained by landmarks. See: https://www.w3.org/WAI/WCAG22/quickref/

MEDIUM

All page content should be contained by landmarks: Fix any of the following: Some page content is not contained by landmarks

Page: /

Element:

```
<div class="controls-l" role="link" tabindex="0" zindex="9998" onclick="showlangl('s
how');" onfocus="showlang('show');" id="lang" title="Show Language options toolbar"
aria-label="Show Language option...
```

SONDE FIX PLAN

Ensure all page content is contained by landmarks. See: https://www.w3.org/WAI/WCAG22/quickref/

MEDIUM

All page content should be contained by landmarks: Fix any of the following: Some page content is not contained by landmarks

Page: /

Element:

```
<div id="skip4" tabindex="0" role="link" class="skipper" onclick="skipto('lang');" o
nkeydown="keypress(event,'skip2lang');" title="skip to language options toolbar" ari
a-label="skip to language option...
```

SONDE FIX PLAN

Ensure all page content is contained by landmarks. See: https://www.w3.org/WAI/WCAG22/quickref/

MEDIUM

All page content should be contained by landmarks: Fix any of the following: Some page content is not contained by landmarks

Page: /

Element:

```
<div id="skip2" tabindex="0" role="link" class="skipper" onclick="skipto('conten
t');" onkeydown="keypress(event,'skip2content');" title="skip to content area" aria-
label="skip to content area">Skip To...
```

SONDE FIX PLAN

Ensure all page content is contained by landmarks. See: https://www.w3.org/WAI/WCAG22/quickref/

MEDIUM

Link is distinguished from surrounding text only by color (link: rgb(16, 71, 90), text: rgb(51, 51, 51)). Users who cannot perceive color differences may not identify this as a link.

WCAG 1.4.1

Page: / WCAG 1.4.1

Element:

```
<a href="https://www.providenceri.gov/inspection-standards/" title="Link to Inspecti
ons and Standards">Construction</a>
```

SONDE FIX PLAN

Add a non-color visual indicator to links: underline (text-decoration: underline), border-bottom, increased font-weight, or a visible icon. The indicator must be present in the default state, not just on hover.

MEDIUM

Link is distinguished from surrounding text only by color (link: rgb(16, 71, 90), text: rgb(51, 51, 51)). Users who cannot perceive color differences may not identify this as a link.

WCAG 1.4.1

Page: / WCAG 1.4.1

Element:

```
<a target="_blank" rel="noreferrer noopener" href="https://library.municode.com/ri/p
rovidence/codes/code_of_ordinances" title="City of Providence Code of Ordinances (op
ens in a new window)">Code of Or
```

SONDE FIX PLAN

Add a non-color visual indicator to links: underline (text-decoration: underline), border-bottom, increased font-weight, or a visible icon. The indicator must be present in the default state, not just on hover.

MEDIUM

Link is distinguished from surrounding text only by color (link: rgb(16, 71, 90), text: rgb(51, 51, 51)). Users who cannot perceive color differences may not identify this as a link.

WCAG 1.4.1

Page: / WCAG 1.4.1

Element:

```
<a href="https://www.providenceri.gov/i-want-to/" title="Quick links I want to commo
n web tasks">I Want to…</a>
```

SONDE FIX PLAN

Add a non-color visual indicator to links: underline (text-decoration: underline), border-bottom, increased font-weight, or a visible icon. The indicator must be present in the default state, not just on hover.

MEDIUM

Link is distinguished from surrounding text only by color (link: rgb(16, 71, 90), text: rgb(51, 51, 51)). Users who cannot perceive color differences may not identify this as a link.

WCAG 1.4.1

Page: / WCAG 1.4.1

Element:

```
<a href="https://www.providenceri.gov/hr/jobs/">Job Opportunities</a>
```

SONDE FIX PLAN

Add a non-color visual indicator to links: underline (text-decoration: underline), border-bottom, increased font-weight, or a visible icon. The indicator must be present in the default state, not just on hover.

MEDIUM

Link is distinguished from surrounding text only by color (link: rgb(16, 71, 90), text: rgb(51, 51, 51)). Users who cannot perceive color differences may not identify this as a link.

WCAG 1.4.1

Page: / WCAG 1.4.1

Element:

```
<a href="https://www.providenceri.gov/board-of-licenses/" title="Board of Licenses f
or a business">Running a Business</a>
```

SONDE FIX PLAN

Add a non-color visual indicator to links: underline (text-decoration: underline), border-bottom, increased font-weight, or a visible icon. The indicator must be present in the default state, not just on hover.

MEDIUM

Link is distinguished from surrounding text only by color (link: rgb(16, 71, 90), text: rgb(51, 51, 51)). Users who cannot perceive color differences may not identify this as a link.

WCAG 1.4.1

Page: / WCAG 1.4.1

Element:

```
<a href="https://www.providenceri.gov/departments/" title="List of City Department
s">Departments</a>
```

SONDE FIX PLAN
Add a non-color visual indicator to links: underline (text-decoration: underline), border-bottom, increased font-weight, or a visible icon. The indicator must be present in the default state, not just on hover.

MEDIUM Link is distinguished from surrounding text only by color (link: rgb(16, 71, 90), text: rgb(51, 51, 51)). Users who cannot perceive color differences may not identify this as a link. WCAG 1.4.1

Page: / WCAG 1.4.1

Element:

```
<a href="https://www.providenceri.gov/ethics/" title="Ethics in Providence">Ethics</a>
```

SONDE FIX PLAN
Add a non-color visual indicator to links: underline (text-decoration: underline), border-bottom, increased font-weight, or a visible icon. The indicator must be present in the default state, not just on hover.

MEDIUM Link is distinguished from surrounding text only by color (link: rgb(16, 71, 90), text: rgb(51, 51, 51)). Users who cannot perceive color differences may not identify this as a link. WCAG 1.4.1

Page: / WCAG 1.4.1

Element:

```
<a href="https://www.providenceri.gov/mayors-office/" title="Mayor of Providence Office">Mayor’s Office</a>
```

SONDE FIX PLAN
Add a non-color visual indicator to links: underline (text-decoration: underline), border-bottom, increased font-weight, or a visible icon. The indicator must be present in the default state, not just on hover.

MEDIUM Link is distinguished from surrounding text only by color (link: rgb(16, 71, 90), text: rgb(51, 51, 51)). Users who cannot perceive color differences may not identify this as a link. WCAG 1.4.1

Page: / WCAG 1.4.1

Element:

```
<a href="https://www.providenceri.gov/purchasing/openrfpsummary/">Purchasing – Open RFPs</a>
```

SONDE FIX PLAN

Add a non-color visual indicator to links: underline (text-decoration: underline), border-bottom, increased font-weight, or a visible icon. The indicator must be present in the default state, not just on hover.

MEDIUM Link is distinguished from surrounding text only by color (link: rgb(16, 71, 90), text: rgb(51, 51, 51)). Users who cannot perceive color differences may not identify this as a link. WCAG 1.4.1

Page: / WCAG 1.4.1

Element:

```
<a href="https://council.providenceri.gov/" title="Link to City Council">City Council</a>
```

SONDE FIX PLAN

Add a non-color visual indicator to links: underline (text-decoration: underline), border-bottom, increased font-weight, or a visible icon. The indicator must be present in the default state, not just on hover.

MEDIUM "Show Accessibility options toolbar" is visually at position 14 but receives focus at position 5 (drift: 9). WCAG 2.4.3

Page: / WCAG 2.4.3

Element:

```
<div>Show Accessibility options toolbar</div>
```

SONDE FIX PLAN

Align DOM order with visual presentation, or use tabIndex to match the visual sequence.

MEDIUM Broken link: https://www.providenceri.gov/pvd311/ returned status 403 Forbidden after 2 attempts

Page: /

Element:

```
<a href="https://www.providenceri.gov/pvd311/">PVD 311</a>
```

MEDIUM Broken link: https://www.providenceri.gov/ethics/ returned status 403 Forbidden after 2 attempts

Page: /

Element:

```
<a href="https://www.providenceri.gov/ethics/">Ethics</a>
```

MEDIUM Broken link: https://www.providenceri.gov/i-want-to returned status 403 Forbidden after 1 attempts

Page: /

Element:

```
<a href="https://www.providenceri.gov/i-want-to">I want to...</a>
```

MEDIUM Broken link: https://www.providenceri.gov/news-events/ returned status 403 Forbidden after 2 attempts

Page: /

Element:

```
<a href="https://www.providenceri.gov/news-events/">NEWS</a>
```

MEDIUM Broken link: https://www.providenceri.gov/inspection-standards/ returned status 403 Forbidden after 2 attempts

Page: /

Element:

```
<a href="https://www.providenceri.gov/inspection-standards/">Construction</a>
```

MEDIUM Broken link: https://www.providenceri.gov/event/ returned status 403 Forbidden after 2 attempts

Page: /

Element:

```
<a href="https://www.providenceri.gov/event/">EVENTS</a>
```

MEDIUM Broken link: https://www.providenceri.gov/parks/ returned status 403 Forbidden after 1 attempts

Page: /

Element:

```
<a href="https://www.providenceri.gov/parks/">Providence Parks</a>
```

MEDIUM Broken link: https://www.providenceri.gov/purchasing returned status 403 Forbidden after 1 attempts

Page: /

Element:

```
<a href="https://www.providenceri.gov/purchasing">Purchasing</a>
```

MEDIUM Broken link: https://www.providenceri.gov/board-of-licenses/ returned status 403 Forbidden after 2 attempts

Page: /

Element:

```
<a href="https://www.providenceri.gov/board-of-licenses/">Running a Business</a>
```

MEDIUM Broken link: https://www.providenceri.gov/pvd-311/ returned status 403 Forbidden after 1 attempts

Page: /

Element:

```
<a href="https://www.providenceri.gov/pvd-311/">PVD 311</a>
```

MEDIUM Broken link: https://www.providenceri.gov/law-department/ada-compliance/ returned status 403 Forbidden after 1 attempts

Page: /

Element:

```
<a href="https://www.providenceri.gov/law-department/ada-compliance/">ACCESSIBILITY
</a>
```

MEDIUM Broken link: https://www.providenceri.gov/purchasing/openrfpsummary/ returned status 403 Forbidden after 2 attempts

Page: /

Element:

```
<a href="https://www.providenceri.gov/purchasing/openrfpsummary/">Purchasing – Open
RFPs</a>
```

MEDIUM Broken link: https://www.providenceri.gov/public-property/private-events/ returned status 403 Forbidden after 2 attempts

Page: /

Element:

```
<a href="https://www.providenceri.gov/public-property/private-events/">City Hall Pri
vate Event</a>
```

LOW Link timeout: https://www.providenceri.gov/law-department/nondiscrimination-policy-statement/ did not respond within 5000ms after 2 attempts

Page: /

Element:

```
<a href="https://www.providenceri.gov/law-department/nondiscrimination-policy-statement/">Accessibility</a>
```

LOW Link timeout: http://wmq.etimspayments.com/pbw/include/providence/input.jsp did not respond within 5000ms after 2 attempts

Page: /

Element:

```
<a href="http://wmq.etimspayments.com/pbw/include/providence/input.jsp">Pay my parking ticket</a>
```

LOW Link timeout: https://www.providenceri.gov/newsletter-spanish/ did not respond within 5000ms after 2 attempts

Page: /

Element:

```
<a href="https://www.providenceri.gov/newsletter-spanish/">Haga clic aquí para español</a>
```

LOW Broken link: http://pvdbusiness.com/business-portal/index.php returned status 404 Not Found after 1 attempts

Page: /

Element:

```
<a href="http://pvdbusiness.com/business-portal/index.php">Starting a Business</a>
```

LOW Link timeout: https://www.providenceri.gov/i-want-to/ did not respond within 5000ms after 2 attempts

Page: /

Element:

```
<a href="https://www.providenceri.gov/i-want-to/">I Want to…</a>
```

LOW Link timeout: https://www.providenceri.gov/city-of-providence-files-enforcement-action-for-unlawful-use-of-rental-algorithms-for-price-coordination/ did not

respond within 5000ms after 2 attempts

Page: /

Element:

```
<a href="https://www.providenceri.gov/city-of-providence-files-enforcement-action-for-unlawful-use-of-rental-algorithms-for-price-coordination/">City of Providence Files Enforcement Action for Unlawful Use of Rental Algorithm</a>
```

LOW Link timeout: https://www.providenceri.gov/tax-collector/online-tax-payment-system/ did not respond within 5000ms after 3 attempts

Page: /

Element:

```
<a href="https://www.providenceri.gov/tax-collector/online-tax-payment-system/">Pay Taxes</a>
```

LOW Link timeout: https://www.providenceri.gov/ did not respond within 5000ms after 2 attempts

Page: /

Element:

```
<a href="https://www.providenceri.gov/">City Of Providence</a>
```

LOW Link timeout: https://translate.google.com/ did not respond within 5000ms after 2 attempts

Page: /

Element:

```
<a href="https://translate.google.com/"></a>
```

LOW Link timeout: https://www.providenceri.gov/mayors-office/ did not respond within 5000ms after 2 attempts

Page: /

Element:

```
<a href="https://www.providenceri.gov/mayors-office/">Mayor Brett Smiley</a>
```

LOW Link timeout: https://www.providenceri.gov/departments/ did not respond within 5000ms after 2 attempts

Page: /

Element:

```
<a href="https://www.providenceri.gov/departments/">Departments</a>
```

LOW Link timeout: https://council.providenceri.gov/ did not respond within 5000ms after 2 attempts

Page: /

Element:

```
<a href="https://council.providenceri.gov/">City Council</a>
```

LOW Link timeout: https://library.municode.com/ri/providence/codes/code_of_ordinances did not respond within 5000ms after 2 attempts

Page: /

Element:

```
<a href="https://library.municode.com/ri/providence/codes/code_of_ordinances">Code of Ordinances</a>
```

LOW Link timeout: https://plan.providenceri.gov/ did not respond within 5000ms after 2 attempts

Page: /

Element:

```
<a href="https://plan.providenceri.gov/">Learn More about the Comp Plan</a>
```

LOW Link timeout: https://www.providenceri.gov/hr/jobs/ did not respond within 5000ms after 2 attempts

Page: /

Element:

```
<a href="https://www.providenceri.gov/hr/jobs/">Job Opportunities</a>
```

LOW Link timeout: https://www.providenceri.gov/vital-records/ did not respond within 5000ms after 2 attempts

Page: /

Element:

```
<a href="https://www.providenceri.gov/vital-records/">Marriage, Birth, Death Certificates</a>
```

LOW Broken link: https://jobs.providenceri.gov/ returned status 403 Forbidden after 1 attempts

Page: /

Element:

```
<a href="https://jobs.providenceri.gov/">Job Opportunities</a>
```

LOW Broken link: https://twitter.com/PVDMayor returned status 403 Forbidden after 1 attempts

Page: /

Element:

```
<a href="https://twitter.com/PVDMayor">Twitter Icon</a>
```

LOW Link timeout: https://www.providenceri.gov/public-works/waste-pickup-schedule/ did not respond within 5000ms after 2 attempts

Page: /

Element:

```
<a href="https://www.providenceri.gov/public-works/waste-pickup-schedule/">Waste Pic
kup Schedule</a>
```

LOW Link timeout: https://www.providenceri.gov/ethics/filings-elected-officials/ did not respond within 5000ms after 2 attempts

Page: /

Element:

```
<a href="https://www.providenceri.gov/ethics/filings-elected-officials/">Details</a>
```

LOW Link timeout: https://www.providenceri.gov/animal-control/adoptions/ did not respond within 5000ms after 2 attempts

Page: /

Element:

```
<a href="https://www.providenceri.gov/animal-control/adoptions/">Animal Adoption</a>
```

LOW Possible stuck loading animation: "spinner-dash" still running after page readiness

Page: /

Element:

```
<circle class="VIpgJd-ZVi9od-aZ2wEe-Jt5cK" fill="none" stroke-width="6" stroke-linec
ap="round" cx="33" cy="33" r="30"></circle>
```

LOW Possible stuck loading animation: "spinner-rotator" still running after page readiness

Page: /

Element:

```
<svg xmlns="http://www.w3.org/2000/svg" class="VIpgJd-ZVi9od-aZ2wEe" width="96px" he
ight="96px" viewBox="0 0 66 66"><circle class="VIpgJd-ZVi9od-aZ2wEe-Jt5cK" fill="non
e" stroke-width="6" stroke-linec
```

Methodology

The Sonde Score is a universal 0–1000 compliance index — think of it like a credit score for accessibility. Each finding is weighted by its impact on human access: a keyboard trap (critical) counts far more than a best-practice suggestion (low). The raw penalty is normalized per page so scores are comparable across sites of any size. A harmonic curve ensures every site gets a meaningful score — no zeros, no false perfection.

```
Score = round(1000 × S / (S + P/N))
```

where S = sensitivity (750), P = Σ(weight × count), N = pages scanned

TIER	WEIGHT	EXAMPLES
Critical	10	Keyboard traps, missing page language
High	3	Missing alt text, insufficient contrast
Medium	1	Heading hierarchy, unclear link purpose
Low	0.25	Best-practice suggestions

The Sonde Score is a living standard (v0.1). We're building it in the open because accessibility is too important for closed-door decisions. Your expertise makes it better.

Enter Mission Control

Review raw findings data, track changes between scans, and contribute to Sonde's open methodology.

View Findings Data | Track Changes | Nominate a Site | Report a Scanning Issue